

BEE 4750 Homework 1: Introduction to Using Julia

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Due Date

Thursday, 9/11/25, 9:00pm

Overview

Instructions

- Problem 1 consist of a series of code snippets for you to interpret and debug. You will be asked to identify relevant error(s) and fix the code.
- Problem 2 asks you to write code to implement several simple functions using more general programming and some which are unique to Julia (which might mean that you need to look at the documentation or use Julia's help function, which is accessed with ?, e.g. `?sum` for help with the `sum()` function) or to analyze Julia syntax.
- Problem 3 asks you to convert a verbal description of a wastewater treatment system into a Julia function, and then to use that function to explore the impact of different wastewater allocation strategies.

Load Environment

The following code loads the environment and makes sure all needed packages are installed. This should be at the start of most Julia scripts.

```
import Pkg
Pkg.activate(@__DIR__)
Pkg.instantiate()
```

```

Activating project at `c:\Users\sarah\OneDrive\Documents\GitHub\bee4750-hw1-sarah-and-nath
  Installed HypergeometricFunctions  v0.3.28
  Installed EarCut_jll                v2.2.4+0
  Installed PDMats                    v0.11.35
  Installed StatsFuns                 v1.5.0
  Installed NetworkLayout             v0.4.10
  Installed ArnoldiMethod             v0.4.0
  Installed OffsetArrays              v1.17.0
  Installed Unitful                   v1.23.1
  Installed StaticArrays              v1.9.14
  Installed Rmath_jll                v0.5.1+0
  Installed StaticArraysCore          v1.4.3
  Installed Ratios                    v0.4.5
  Installed SpecialFunctions          v2.5.1
  Installed GeometryTypes             v0.8.5
  Installed ColorTypes               v0.11.5
  Installed GraphRecipes              v0.5.14
  Installed Extents                   v0.1.6
  Installed AbstractTrees             v0.4.5
  Installed Inflate                   v0.1.5
  Installed OpenSpecFun_jll          v0.5.6+0
  Installed ColorVectorSpace          v0.10.0
  Installed ChainRulesCore            v1.25.2
  Installed Graphs                    v1.13.0
  Installed SimpleTraits              v0.9.4
  Installed Interpolations            v0.16.1
  Installed Adapt                    v4.3.0
  Installed Rmath                     v0.8.0
  Installed IterTools                 v1.10.0
  Installed GeometryBasics            v0.5.10
  Installed FillArrays                v1.13.0
  Installed WoodburyMatrices          v1.0.0
  Installed AxisAlgorithms            v1.1.0
  Installed QuadGK                    v2.11.2
  Installed Distributions              v0.25.120
Precompiling project...
  1591.6 ms  Extents
  1590.8 ms  Ratios
  1526.6 ms  StaticArraysCore
  1585.5 ms  Inflate
  1688.2 ms  IterTools
  1674.4 ms  AbstractTrees
  1582.8 ms  Adapt

```

2133.2 ms	OffsetArrays
1724.8 ms	FillArrays
1471.6 ms	Rmath_jll
1808.6 ms	EarCut_jll
1917.8 ms	SimpleTraits
2179.8 ms	OpenSpecFun_jll
2300.4 ms	ChainRulesCore
1151.8 ms	Ratios → RatiosFixedPointNumbersExt
3629.8 ms	SuiteSparse
3709.8 ms	WoodburyMatrices
1362.4 ms	Adapt → AdaptSparseArraysExt
2384.8 ms	QuadGK
4401.4 ms	ColorTypes
1485.1 ms	OffsetArrays → OffsetArraysAdaptExt
1172.6 ms	FillArrays → FillArraysStatisticsExt
1254.8 ms	FillArrays → FillArraysSparseArraysExt
2077.0 ms	Rmath
1173.5 ms	AxisAlgorithms
1487.4 ms	PDMats
2000.3 ms	ChainRulesCore → ChainRulesCoreSparseArraysExt
2373.3 ms	LogExpFunctions → LogExpFunctionsChainRulesCoreExt
1274.3 ms	FillArrays → FillArraysPDMatsExt
	Conda
4608.5 ms	SpecialFunctions
3166.3 ms	ColorVectorSpace
2020.8 ms	HypergeometricFunctions
9503.6 ms	StaticArrays
2962.3 ms	ColorVectorSpace → SpecialFunctionsExt
5950.7 ms	Colors
3617.7 ms	SpecialFunctions → SpecialFunctionsChainRulesCoreExt
	Julia
1463.9 ms	Adapt → AdaptStaticArraysExt
3323.3 ms	StatsFuns
2501.2 ms	StaticArrays → StaticArraysStatisticsExt
2669.6 ms	StaticArrays → StaticArraysChainRulesCoreExt
3478.7 ms	ArnoldiMethod
2882.1 ms	StatsFuns → StatsFunsChainRulesCoreExt
3165.0 ms	GeometryTypes
3470.4 ms	Interpolations
6980.9 ms	ColorSchemes
6550.6 ms	Distributions
7231.9 ms	Graphs
23318.6 ms	Unitful

```

3635.8 ms    Distributions → DistributionsChainRulesCoreExt
4471.0 ms    Distributions → DistributionsTestExt
3213.6 ms    Unitful → PrintfExt
14670.1 ms   GeometryBasics
4338.7 ms    Interpolations → InterpolationsUnitfulExt
2767.3 ms    UnitfulLatexify
3932.9 ms    NetworkLayout
11760.8 ms   PlotUtils
2546.6 ms    NetworkLayout → NetworkLayoutGraphsExt
4909.0 ms    RecipesPipeline
5089.4 ms    PlotThemes
4292.2 ms    GraphRecipes
62394.7 ms   Plots
5973.3 ms    Plots → UnitfulExt
5945.0 ms    Plots → GeometryBasicsExt
              Plots → IJuliaExt

```

63 dependencies successfully precompiled in 111 seconds. 174 already precompiled.

The following 2 direct dependencies failed to precompile:

IJuliaExt

Failed to precompile IJuliaExt [2f4121a4-3b3a-5ce6-9c5e-1f2673ce168a] to "C:\\Users\\sarah\\
ERROR: LoadError: IJulia not properly installed. Please run Pkg.build("IJulia")

Stacktrace:

```

[1] error(s::String)
   @ Base .\\error.jl:35
[2] top-level scope
   @ C:\\Users\\sarah\\.julia\\packages\\IJulia\\eenvU\\src\\IJulia.jl:50
[3] include
   @ .\\Base.jl:557 [inlined]
[4] include_package_for_output(pkg::Base.PkgId, input::String, depot_path::Vector{String}, o
   @ Base .\\loading.jl:2881
[5] top-level scope
   @ stdin:6

```

in expression starting at C:\\Users\\sarah\\.julia\\packages\\IJulia\\eenvU\\src\\IJulia.jl:1

in expression starting at stdin:6

ERROR: LoadError: Failed to precompile IJulia [7073ff75-c697-5162-941a-fcdaad2a7d2a] to "C:\\

Stacktrace:

```

[1] error(s::String)
   @ Base .\\error.jl:35
[2] compilecache(pkg::Base.PkgId, path::String, internal_stderr::IO, internal_stdout::IO, l
   @ Base .\\loading.jl:3174

```

```

[3] (::Base.var"#1110#1111"{Base.PkgId})()
    @ Base .\loading.jl:2579
[4] mkpidlock(f::Base.var"#1110#1111"{Base.PkgId}, at::String, pid::Int32; kwopts::@Kwargs{
    @ FileWatching.Pidfile C:\Users\sarah\.julia\juliaup\julia-1.11.5+0.x64.w64.mingw32\share
[5] #mkpidlock#6
    @ C:\Users\sarah\.julia\juliaup\julia-1.11.5+0.x64.w64.mingw32\share\julia\stdlib\v1.11\
[6] trymkpidlock(::Function, ::Vararg{Any}; kwargs::@Kwargs{stale_age::Int64})
    @ FileWatching.Pidfile C:\Users\sarah\.julia\juliaup\julia-1.11.5+0.x64.w64.mingw32\share
[7] #invokelatest#2
    @ .\essentials.jl:1057 [inlined]
[8] invokelatest
    @ .\essentials.jl:1052 [inlined]
[9] maybe_cache_file_lock(f::Base.var"#1110#1111"{Base.PkgId}, pkg::Base.PkgId, srcpath::String)
    @ Base .\loading.jl:3698
[10] maybe_cache_file_lock
    @ .\loading.jl:3695 [inlined]
[11] _require(pkg::Base.PkgId, env::Nothing)
    @ Base .\loading.jl:2565
[12] __require_prelocked(uuidkey::Base.PkgId, env::Nothing)
    @ Base .\loading.jl:2388
[13] #invoke_in_world#3
    @ .\essentials.jl:1089 [inlined]
[14] invoke_in_world
    @ .\essentials.jl:1086 [inlined]
[15] _require_prelocked
    @ .\loading.jl:2375 [inlined]
[16] _require_prelocked
    @ .\loading.jl:2374 [inlined]
[17] macro expansion
    @ .\lock.jl:273 [inlined]
[18] require(uuidkey::Base.PkgId)
    @ Base .\loading.jl:2371
[19] top-level scope
    @ C:\Users\sarah\.julia\packages\Plots\gYkEG\ext\IJuliaExt.jl:6
[20] include
    @ .\Base.jl:557 [inlined]
[21] include_package_for_output(pkg::Base.PkgId, input::String, depot_path::Vector{String},
    @ Base .\loading.jl:2881
[22] top-level scope
    @ stdin:6
in expression starting at C:\Users\sarah\.julia\packages\Plots\gYkEG\ext\IJuliaExt.jl:1
in expression starting at stdin:6
IJulia

```

```
Failed to precompile IJulia [7073ff75-c697-5162-941a-fcdaad2a7d2a] to "C:\\Users\\sarah\\.julia\\cache\\IJulia\\7073ff75-c697-5162-941a-fcdaad2a7d2a"
ERROR: LoadError: IJulia not properly installed. Please run Pkg.build("IJulia")
```

```
Stacktrace:
```

```
[1] error(s::String)
  @ Base .\error.jl:35
[2] top-level scope
  @ C:\Users\sarah\.julia\packages\IJulia\eenvU\src\IJulia.jl:50
[3] include
  @ .\Base.jl:557 [inlined]
[4] include_package_for_output(pkg::Base.PkgId, input::String, depot_path::Vector{String}, depot_name::String)
  @ Base .\loading.jl:2881
[5] top-level scope
  @ stdin:6
in expression starting at C:\Users\sarah\.julia\packages\IJulia\eenvU\src\IJulia.jl:1
in expression starting at stdin:6
```

Standard Julia practice is to load all needed packages at the top of a file. If you need to load any additional packages in any assignments beyond those which are loaded by default, feel free to add a `using` statement, though [you may need to install the package](#).

```
using Random
using Plots
using GraphRecipes
using LaTeXStrings
using Distributions
```

```
# this sets a random seed, which ensures reproducibility of random number generation. You should
Random.seed!(1)
```

```
TaskLocalRNG()
```

Problems (Total: 30 Points)

Problem 1 (12 points)

The following subproblems all involve code snippets that require debugging. You are encouraged to use online resources (*e.g.* Julia documentation and forums, Stack Overflow, Reddit, etc) to help find diagnose error messages and find solutions, but make sure that you clearly document which resources you used and how you used them.

Problem 1.1

You've been tasked with writing code to identify the minimum value in an array. You cannot use a predefined function. Your colleague suggested the function below, but it does not return the minimum value.

```
function minimum(array)
    # initialize the minimum value counter
    min_value = 0
    # update minimum values
    for i in 1:length(array)
        if array[i] < min_value
            min_value = array[i]
        end
    end
    # return found minimum
    return min_value
end

array_values = [89, 90, 95, 100, 100, 78, 99, 98, 100, 95]
@show minimum(array_values);
```

```
minimum(array_values) = 0
```

What is the logical flaw in the code? Fix it and show that your fixed code solves the problem.

Problem 1.2

Your team is trying to compute the average grade for your class, but the following code produces an `UndefVarError`.

```
# enter student grade vector
student_grades = [89, 90, 95, 100, 100, 78, 99, 98, 100, 95]
# compute class average
function class_average(grades)
    average_grade = mean(student_grades)
    return average_grade
end

@show average_grade;
```

```
UndefVarError: UndefVarError: `average_grade` not defined in `Main`  
Suggestion: check for spelling errors or missing imports.  
UndefVarError: `average_grade` not defined in `Main`
```

Suggestion: check for spelling errors or missing imports.

Stacktrace:

```
[1] macro expansion
```

```
@ show.jl:1232 [inlined]
```

```
[2] top-level scope
```

```
@ c:\Users\sarah\OneDrive\Documents\GitHub\bee4750-hw1-sarah-and-nathan\jl_notebook_cell_0
```

What does this `UndefVarError` mean? Why does this code produce one? Fix the error and solve the problem.

Problem 1.3

Your team wants to know the expected payout of an old Italian dice game called *passadieci* (which was analyzed by Galileo as one of the first examples of a rigorous study of probability). The goal of *passadieci* is to get at least an 11 from rolling three fair, six-sided dice. Your strategy is to compute the average wins from 1,000 trials, but the code you've written below produces a `MethodError`.

```
# function to simulate a passedieci roll: 3 6-sided dice  
function passedieci()  
    # this rand() call samples 3 values from the vector [1, 6]  
    roll = rand(1:6, 3)  
    return roll  
end  
# set number of trials and initialize outcome vector  
n_trials = 1_000  
outcomes = zero(n_trials)  
# simulate number of passedieci rolls and count wins  
for i = 1:n_trials  
    outcomes[i] = (sum(passadieci()) > 11)  
end
```



```
win_prob = sum(outcomes) / n_trials # compute average number of wins
@show win_prob;
```

MethodError: MethodError: no method matching setindex!{::Int64, ::Bool, ::Int64}

The function `setindex!` exists, but no method is defined for this combination of argument types

MethodError: no method matching setindex!{::Int64, ::Bool, ::Int64}

The function `setindex!` exists, but no method is defined for this combination of argument types

Stacktrace:

[1] top-level scope

@ c:\Users\sarah\OneDrive\Documents\GitHub\bee4750-hw1-sarah-and-nathan\jl_notebook_cell_0

What does this `MethodError` mean? Why does this code produce one? Fix the error and solve the problem.

Problem 1.4

You're interested in writing some code to remove the mean of a vector from all of its components. You've written the following code and tried to test it on a random vector, but your code returns a `MethodError`.

```
# function to remove mean from a vector
function remove_mean(vect)
    # function to compute the mean
    function compute_mean(vect)
        element_sum = 0 # initialize sum
        # compute mean and return
        for v in vect
            element_sum += v
        end
        return element_sum / length(vect)
    end

    m = compute_mean(vect) # compute mean
    # return demeaned vector
    return vect - m
```

```

end

random_vect = rand(1_000)
@show remove_mean(random_vect)

```

MethodError: MethodError: no method matching `-(::Vector{Float64}, ::Float64)`
 For element-wise subtraction, use broadcasting with dot syntax: `array .- scalar`
 The function ``-`` exists, but no method is defined for this combination of argument types.

Closest candidates are:

```

-(!Matched::Missing, ::Number)
  @ Base missing.jl:123
-(!Matched::ChainRulesCore.NoTangent, ::Any)
  @ ChainRulesCore C:\Users\sarah\.julia\packages\ChainRulesCore\XAgYn\src\tangent_arithmet...
-(::Any, !Matched::ChainRulesCore.NotImplemented)
  @ ChainRulesCore C:\Users\sarah\.julia\packages\ChainRulesCore\XAgYn\src\tangent_arithmet...
...

```

MethodError: no method matching `-(::Vector{Float64}, ::Float64)`

For element-wise subtraction, use broadcasting with dot syntax: `array .- scalar`

The function ``-`` exists, but no method is defined for this combination of argument types.

Closest candidates are:

```

-(!Matched::Missing, ::Number)

  @ Base missing.jl:123

-(!Matched::ChainRulesCore.NoTangent, ::Any)

  @ ChainRulesCore C:\Users\sarah\.julia\packages\ChainRulesCore\XAgYn\src\tangent_arithmet...

-(::Any, !Matched::ChainRulesCore.NotImplemented)

  @ ChainRulesCore C:\Users\sarah\.julia\packages\ChainRulesCore\XAgYn\src\tangent_arithmet...

...

```

Stacktrace:

```
[1] remove_mean(vect::Vector{Float64})

@ Main c:\Users\sarah\OneDrive\Documents\GitHub\bee4750-hw1-sarah-and-nathan\jl_notebook_

[2] macro expansion

@ show.jl:1232 [inlined]

[3] top-level scope

@ c:\Users\sarah\OneDrive\Documents\GitHub\bee4750-hw1-sarah-and-nathan\jl_notebook_cell_
```

What does this `MethodError` mean? Why does this code produce one? Fix the error and solve the problem.

Problem 2 (18 points)

Cheap Plastic Products, Inc. is operating a plant that produces $100\text{m}^3/\text{day}$ of wastewater that is discharged into Pristine Brook. The wastewater contains $1\text{kg}/\text{m}^3$ of YUK, a toxic substance. The US Environmental Protection Agency has imposed an effluent standard on the plant prohibiting discharge of more than $20\text{kg}/\text{day}$ of YUK into Pristine Brook.

Cheap Plastic Products has analyzed two methods for reducing its discharges of YUK. Method 1 is land disposal, which costs $X_1^2/20$ dollars per day, where X_1 is the amount of wastewater disposed of on the land (m^3/day). With this method, 20% of the YUK applied to the land will eventually drain into the stream (*i.e.*, 80% of the YUK is removed by the soil).

Method 2 is a chemical treatment procedure which costs $\$1.50$ per m^3 of wastewater treated. The chemical treatment has an efficiency of $e = 1 - 0.005X_2$, where X_2 is the quantity of wastewater (m^3/day) treated. For example, if $X_2 = 50\text{m}^3/\text{day}$, then $e = 1 - 0.005(50) = 0.75$, so that 75% of the YUK is removed.

Cheap Plastic Products is wondering how to allocate their wastewater between these three disposal and treatment methods (land disposal, chemical treatment, and direct disposal) to meet the effluent standard while keeping costs manageable.

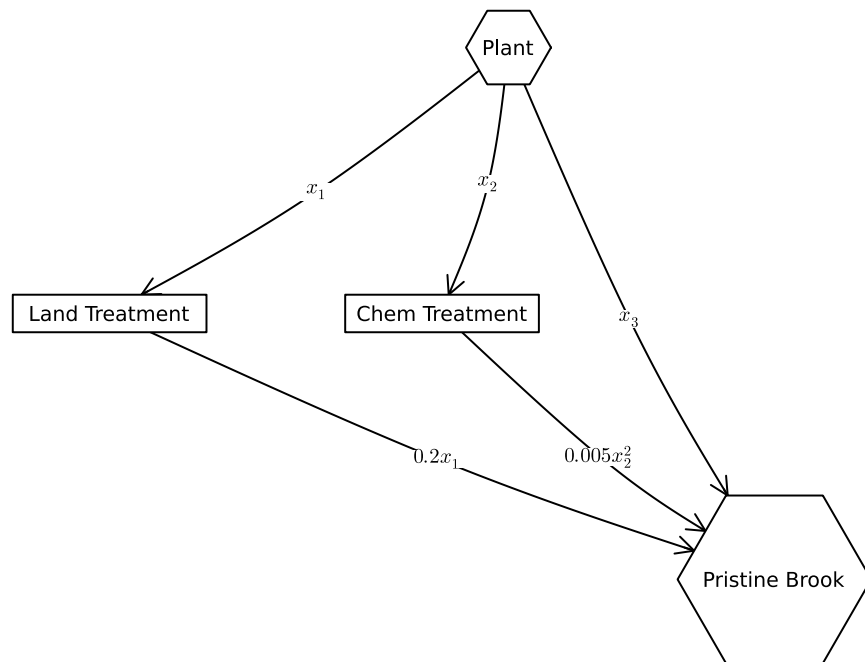
The flow of wastewater through this treatment system is shown in Figure 1. Modify the edge labels (by editing the `edge_labels` dictionary in the code producing Figure 1) to show how

the wastewater allocations result in the final YUK discharge into Pristine Brook. For the `edge_label` dictionary, the tuple (i, j) corresponds to the arrow going from node i to node j . The syntax for any entry is $(i, j) \Rightarrow \text{"label text"}$, and the label text can include mathematical notation if the string is prefaced with an L, as in `L"x_1"` will produce x_1 .

```
A = [0 1 1 1;
      0 0 0 1;
      0 0 0 1;
      0 0 0 0]

names = ["Plant", "Land Treatment", "Chem Treatment", "Pristine Brook"]
# modify this dictionary to add labels
edge_labels = Dict((1, 2) => L"x_1", (1,3) => L"x_2", (1, 4) => L"x_3", (2, 4) => L"0.2x_1", (3, 4) => L"0.005x_2^2")
shapes=[:hexagon, :rect, :rect, :hexagon]
xpos = [0, -1.5, -0.25, 1]
ypos = [1, 0, 0, -1]

p = graphplot(A, names=names, edgelabel=edge_labels, markersize=0.15, markershapes=shapes, margin=10)
display(p)
```



Problem 2.1

Formulate a mathematical model for the treatment cost and the amount of YUK that will be discharged into Pristine Brook based on the wastewater allocations. This is best done with some equations and supporting text explaining the derivation. Make sure you include, as additional equations in the model, any needed constraints on relevant values. You can find some basics on writing mathematical equations using the LaTeX typesetting syntax [here](#), and a cheatsheet with LaTeX commands can be found on the course website's [Resources page](#).

Variables and constraints

Volume of wastewater disposed on land: $x_1 \geq 0$

Volume of wastewater chemically treated: $x_2 \geq 0$

Volume of wastewater disposed directly from plant: $x_3 \geq 0$

Equations

Overall wastewater flow: $x_1 + x_2 + x_3 = 100$

The total volume of wastewater analyzed in this problem is 100 m^3 , so all three wastewater flows should be equal to that value.

YUK discharged into Pristine Brook: $0.2x_1 + 0.005x_2^2 + x_3 \geq 20$

Problem 2.2

Implement your systems model as a Julia function which computes the resulting YUK discharge and cost for a particular treatment plan. You can return multiple values from a function with a [tuple](#), as in:

```
function multiple_return_values(x, y)
    return (x+y, x*y)
end

a, b = multiple_return_values(2, 5)
@show a;
@show b;
```

```
a = 7
b = 10
```

To evaluate the function over vectors of inputs, you can *broadcast* the function by adding a decimal `.` before the function arguments and accessing the resulting values by writing a *comprehension* to loop over the individual outputs in the vector:

```
x = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
y = [6, 7, 8, 9, 10]

output = multiple_return_values.(x, y)
a = [out[1] for out in output]
b = [out[2] for out in output]
@show a;
@show b;
```

```
a = [7, 9, 11, 13, 15]
b = [6, 14, 24, 36, 50]
```

Make sure you comment your code appropriately to make it clear what is going on and why.

Problem 2.3

Use your function to experiment with 1,000 different combinations of wastewater discharge and treatment. You can do this with either a grid search or by sampling from a [Dirichlet distribution](#) (a $\text{Dirichlet}(1, n)$ distribution will generate uniformly-weighted n -dimensional vectors whose components add up to 1; see the [Distributions.jl documentation](#) for how to sample from probability distributions in Julia). Plot the results of these experiments. Do any satisfy the YUK effluent standard (plot this as well as a dashed red line). What was the cost of solutions satisfying the standard? What can you say about the tradeoff between treatment cost and YUK discharge? You don't have to find an "optimal" solution to this problem, but what do you think would be needed to find a better solution?

Problem 2.4

Find the strategies which minimize cost and YUK discharge (these will be different strategies) analytically and find the values of the objective metrics. Plot these values in the plot that you created for Problem 2.3. How do their values compare to the spread of values that you found in that problem? Would you select either of them (explain why or why not)?

References

List any external references consulted, including classmates.